

July 22, 2026 11:00 PM GMT

SpaceX | North America

Anomalies and Rapid Unscheduled Disassemblies

Investors should have realistic expectations about anomalies that can potentially delay SpaceX Connectivity and AI milestones, contributing to earnings and stock price volatility. Despite the challenges, we note SpaceX has demonstrated >99% success rate with its launches – significantly above peers.

Longtime space geeks will tell you, 'space is hard.' They are not wrong. Others will say: "When it comes to space... failure is not an option." That is wrong. In space, failure is not just an option... it's a vital part of the testing and improvement process. If the engineers in the Apollo program were not allowed to fail, we would have never put men on the moon. Anomalies are, in fact, an unavoidable part of pushing the scientific boundaries of space. Investors should have realistic expectations about the physical realities of space. **An investment in SpaceX is an exercise in 'the art of the possible,' grounded in physical reality.** It may be tempting to say "it's not rocket science"... but in this case *it actually is*.

Implications for SpaceX stock at <\$120:

- Anomalies provide short-term buying opportunities for investors to gain exposure to a leader in space and physical AI infrastructure.
- Sentiment has continued to fall after the first scrubbing of Starship flight 13 that a successful (minimal anomaly) test could prove to be a modest boost (5%-type) to the stock.
- At \$115, the stock trades at a discount to our base case valuation of the Space and Connectivity divisions (\$136) with no contribution from AI - either terrestrial or orbital.
- In our base case, Space + Starlink together is \$136/share. At \$115 and using the same 2028 multiple (~55x) for Space + Starlink, it would imply EBITDA forecasts that are 15% below are forecasts (again - zero AI contribution).
- At \$115, the stock trades at 22x EV/EBIT on our 2028 forecasts, in between megacap AI enablers such as GE Vernova (23x) and AMD (26x), which trade at a slight premium to SPCX; and hyperscalers such as Alphabet (17x) and Amazon (~16x), which trade at a modest discount.

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SpaceX (SPCX.O, SPCX US)					
Space Technology United States of America					
Stock Rating	Overweight				
Industry View	Attractive				
Price target	\$300.00				
Shr price, close (Jul 22, 2026)	\$115.26				
52-Week Range	\$225.64-115.26				
Fiscal Year Ending	12/25	12/26e	12/27e	12/28e	
EPS (\$)**	(1.69)	0.28	2.18	6.29	
Prior EPS (\$)**	-	-	-	-	
P/E	NM	407.1	52.8	18.3	
EPS (\$)§	-	(0.42)	0.63	3.24	
Div yld (%)	-	0.0	0.0	0.0	

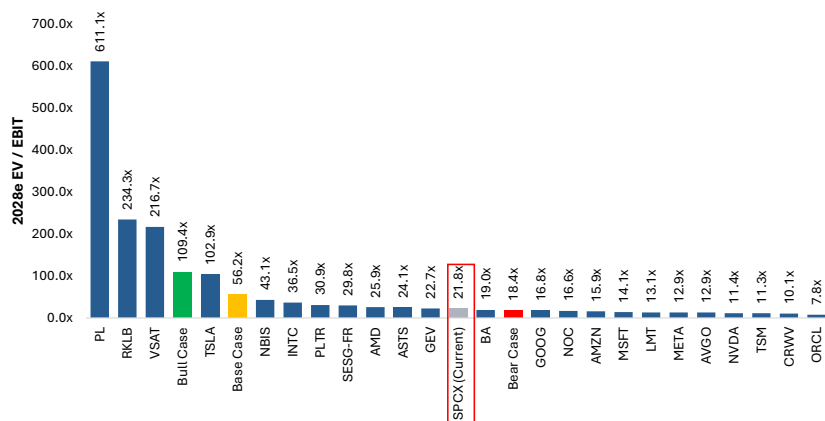
Unless otherwise noted, all metrics are based on Morgan Stanley ModelWare framework
** = Based on consensus methodology
§ = Consensus data is provided by Refinitiv Estimates
e = Morgan Stanley Research estimates

QUARTERLY EPS (\$)					
Quarter	2025	2026e Prior	2026e Current	2027e Prior	2027e Current
Q1	(0.18)	-	(0.84)a	-	0.54
Q2	(0.34)	-	(0.35)	-	0.55
Q3	(0.36)	-	0.27	-	0.54
Q4	(0.80)	-	0.45	-	0.56

e = Morgan Stanley Research estimates, a = Actual Company reported data

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Exhibit 1: SpaceX 2028 EV/EBIT vs. Notable Comps

Note: Uses MS Research estimates for SpaceX (bull and bear cases use respective estimates).

Source: FactSet (as of 7/22/2026), Morgan Stanley Research

SpaceX Anomalies (2023–Mid-2026)

Starship Program (primary source of issues):

- **Flight 1 (Apr 2023):** Vehicle lost minutes after launch due to multiple booster engine failures and fires.
- **Flight 2 (Nov 2023):** Booster failed during boostback burn; ship lost due to fire after propellant venting.
- **Flight 3 (Mar 2024):** Reached higher altitude but both stages lost during reentry and landing attempts.
- **Flights 4–6 (2024):** Major improvement. Successful splashdowns; Flight 5 achieved first booster tower catch.
- **Flight 7 (Jan 2025):** Booster caught, but ship lost from propellant leak and cascading engine shutdowns.
- **Flight 8 (Mar 2025):** Ship lost mid-flight after engine failure.
- **Flight 9 (May 2025):** Anomalies on both booster and ship stages.
- **Ground test (Jun 2025):** Ship 36 exploded during static fire prep (damaged pressure vessel).
- **Flight 10 (Aug 2025):** Booster soft-splashed in the Gulf; ship reached space, deployed payload, and survived reentry. First full version 2 success.
- **Flight 11 (Oct 2025):** Both stages nailed pinpoint splashdowns; a clean finale for the Version 2 design.
- **Flight 12 (May 2026):** Booster failed landing burn and crashed into Gulf of America. First Version 3 flight.
- **Flight 13 (July 2026, Initial attempt):** Four engines failed to ignite at liftoff triggering an automatic abort.

Falcon 9 performance since 2023:

- Extremely reliable overall.
- July 2024: The one true mission failure. An upper-stage engine failed on its second burn, stranding 20 Starlink satellites in a decaying orbit. All lost.
- Booster losses (Aug 2024, Mar 2025): Two first-stage boosters were lost on landing. One tipped over and exploded on the droneship (ending a 267-

landing streak), the other caught fire after touchdown. In both cases the payloads reached orbit fine; only reusability was affected.

- SpaceX has shown rapid iteration and learning from each event, with engine reliability, propellant management, and reentry/landing stresses as recurring challenges.

Crewed missions (100% success rate)

- SpaceX has flown **20 crewed missions** carrying **78 crew members** from 20 countries.
- These are all orbital crewed flights on Falcon 9/Crew Dragon. No crewed Starship missions have flown yet (though plans exist for future ones).

Excluding SpaceX's Falcon launches, the rest of the launch industry attempted 285 orbital launches in 2024 and 2025, recording 15 outright failures and 2 partial failures. Against that benchmark, Falcon 9's >99% operational full-mission success rate ranks among the industry's best, despite an initial recovery-development campaign in which only 6 of the 16 initial controlled-descent test flights achieved both a soft landing and booster recovery. Space is hard for everyone: anomalies, delays and losses of critical hardware are an unfortunate reality of the industry. Repeated failures can erode investor conviction and may require repeated successes to restore. ***What has historically set SpaceX apart is its willingness to test aggressively, fail and learn quickly, and eventually turn repeated setbacks into reliable operational capability.***

Please see here for our SpaceX Initiation: [SpaceX: AI's Final Frontier; Initiate at Overweight, PT \\$300 \(7 Jul 2026\)](#)

Exhibit 2: Starship Flight Test History

Starship Flight	Date	Starship generation	Stage separation	Ship ascent completed	Booster controlled descent	Booster catch / recovery	Payload deployment	Controlled ship reentry / splashdown
Flight 1	Apr 2023	V1	✗	✗	—	—	—	—
Flight 2	Nov 2023	V1	✓	✗	✗	—	—	—
Flight 3	Mar 2024	V1	✓	✓	✗	—	—	✗
Flight 4	Jun 2024	V1	✓	✓	✓	—	—	✓
Flight 5	Oct 2024	V1	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
Flight 6	Nov 2024	V1	✓	✓	✓	—	—	✓
Flight 7	Jan 2025	V2	✓	✗	✓	✓	—	—
Flight 8	Mar 2025	V2	✓	✗	✓	✓	—	—
Flight 9	May 2025	V2	✓	✓	✗	—	✗	✗
Flight 10	Aug 2025	V2	✓	✓	✓	—	✓	✓
Flight 11	Oct 2025	V2	✓	✓	✓	—	✓	✓
Flight 12	May 2026	V3	✓	✓	✗	—	✓	✓

✓ Achieved ✗ Not achieved / partially achieved — Skipped / not reached

Source: SpaceX official launch reports, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 3: Collection of [Various Falcon 9 Anomalies](#) During Booster Landing Tests



Source: SpaceX, Morgan Stanley Research

Valuation Methodology and Risks

SpaceX (SPCX.O)

Sum-of-the-Parts by Segment: Space, Connectivity, AI (Divided into X & Grok and Enterprise AI)

- \$300 Price Target = sum of Space (\$8), Connectivity (\$128), X & Grok (\$12), Enterprise AI (\$152)

2040 ending forecast period

6/30/2027 valuation date

11.1% WACC; 11.9% Cost of Equity

50% Enterprise AI valuation discount for execution risk

TGR of: 4.0% Space, 4.5% connectivity, 3.0% X & Grok, 5.0% Enterprise AI

Equates to 0.41 EV/EBIT/Growth

Risks to Upside

- Faster Starship reuse progress
- Faster Starlink capacity growth
- Stronger DTC / enterprise adoption
- More neocloud wins
- Cursor ARR acceleration
- Lower AI infrastructure time to power and cost

Risks to Downside

- Slower Starship reuse cadence
- Slower Starlink subscriber growth
- Weaker enterprise AI monetization
- Higher capex / cost per watt of compute
- Longer time-to-power
- Greater funding needs / dilution
- Regulatory delays

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(as of June 30, 2026)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1544	42%	453	49%	29%	757	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1577	43%	390	42%	25%	769	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	1	0%	33%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	544	15%	89	10%	16%	204	12%
Total	3,668		933			1731	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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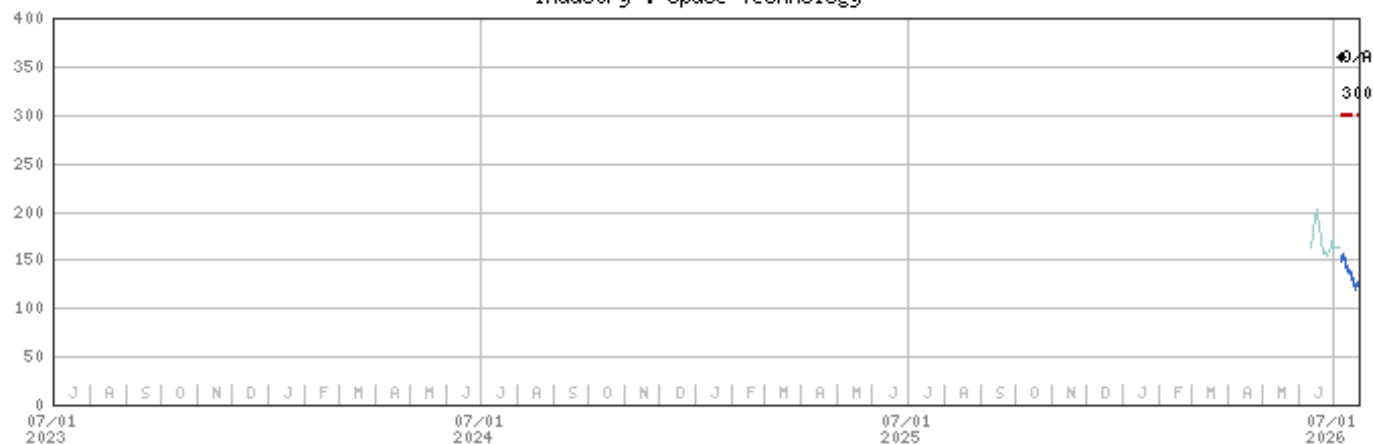
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Stock Price, Price Target and Rating History (See Rating Definitions)

SpaceX (SPCX.O) - As of 07/22/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Space Technology



Stock Rating History: 7/7/26 : O/A

Price Target History: 7/7/26 : 300

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target -- No Price Target Assigned (NA)

Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —

Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ★ Stock Rating/Industry View

Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)

Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Space Technology

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (07/21/2026)
Adam Jonas, CFA		
SpaceX (SPCX.O)	O (07/07/2026)	\$123.54
Justin M Lang		

Gogo Inc (GOGO.O)	E (08/14/2025)	\$3.60
Iridium Communications Inc (IRDM.O)	E (01/16/2026)	\$47.24
MDA Space Ltd (MDA.TO)	O (01/16/2026)	C\$44.47
Viasat Inc (VSAT.O)	E (12/15/2017)	\$73.69
Kristine T Liwag		
Firefly Aerospace Inc (FLY.O)	E (09/02/2025)	\$21.11
HawkEye 360 Inc (HAWK.N)	O (06/01/2026)	\$19.14
Planet Labs PBC (PL.N)	E (01/22/2023)	\$22.60
Rocket Lab USA Inc (RKL.B.O)	O (01/16/2026)	\$69.12
Virgin Galactic Holdings Inc (SPCE.N)	U (11/22/2023)	\$2.67
Voyager Technologies Inc (VOYG.N)	U (07/15/2026)	\$26.39

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* Historical prices are not split adjusted.